Himachal Pradesh : A New Model of Social Welfare

The Jai Ram Thakur-led government in Himachal Pradesh has given its people a reason to rejoice. It has taken a raft of path-breaking decisions on public-centric welfare schemes to create a history of sorts among states in the country, thus living up to the Honourable Prime Minister's oft-quoted catchword **"Sabh ka Saath, Sabh Ka Vikas, Sabh Ka Vishwas, Sabh Ka Prayas"**.

The State Government has taken a historic decision to not charge any bills from the electricity consumers till the consumption of 125 units besides exempting people of the rural areas from paying water bills. The government is also providing 50 percent concession to the women in the fare in State Transport buses operating within the state.



> The State Government is committed to providing social justice to all with special focus on the deprived and marginal sections of society. Welfare and development-oriented schemes has been launched in the state during the four-and-a-half-year tenure of the present government, to ameliorate the socio-economic conditions of the poor and the downtrodden.
>
> **JAI RAM THAKUR**
> Chief Minister

The Jai Ram Thakur Government in Himachal Pradesh has given a top priority when it comes to the welfare of senior citizens, womenfolk, and, to cap it all, the specially-abled in the state. The government has laid special emphasis on the socio-economic well-being of the weaker sections and addressing citizens' grievances on a priority basis. It has endeavoured to provide responsive and transparent governance to ensure welfare of all sections of the society.

HUMANE APPROACH IN POLICIES AND PROGRAMMES OF GOVERNMENT

Jai Ram Thakur hails from a remote village in the interiors of Mandi district. He has himself lived and experienced the difficulties of the common man and that is why has tried to redress these by formulating policies and programmes focused on the common man.

SOCIAL SECURITY PENSION

Today, more than 3.33 lakh beneficiaries (60 years of age and above) are being given the old-age pension of Rs 1700 per month in HP. Widows and people with 40 to 69 percent disability receive a monthly pension of Rs 1150, while those with 70 percent and above receive a monthly pension of Rs 1700. Transgender people and leprosy patients are also being given a monthly pension of Rs 1000. There are a total of 6,35,375 social security pension beneficiaries in the State. Nearly Rs 3,052 crore has been spent under the scheme.

SWARNA JAYANTI NARI SAMBAL YOJANA

The 'Swarna Jayanti Nari Sambal Yojana' was notified by the HP Government in May 2021, as part of the old age pension scheme, under which all eligible women aged 65 to 69 years are being given a social security pension of Rs 1150/-per month without any income limit, provided they are not taking a pension from government service, and are not income tax payers.

MUKHYAMANTRI SHAGUN YOJANA

An amount of Rs 31,000 is being provided under the Mukhyamantri Shagun Yojana as financial assistance for the marriage of girls belonging to families living below the poverty line. 5,308 girls have been provided with financial assistance of Rs 16.45 crore.

MUKHYAMANTRI KANYADAN YOJANA

Financial assistance of Rs 51,000 is being provided for the marriage of girls belonging to poor families. The scheme has been implemented to honour the girl child and to ensure that the girls from poor families are married gracefully.



> It is time to work on new possibilities for Himachal. Himachal has played a leading role in the fulfillment of every national resolution. This enthusiasm will continue in the time to come.
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> **NARENDRA MODI**
> Prime Minister

BETI HAI ANMOL YOJANA

The Himachal Government is providing a lump sum assistance grant of Rs 21,000 to the first born child of a BPL family. Rs 40 crore has been spent to benefit 1,35,065 people under the Beti Hai Anmol Yojana.

EK BUTA BETI KE NAAM

This visionary scheme was launched by the HP Government in December 2019. The objective of this scheme is to plant saplings in the name of a new-born girl child and to make people aware of the importance of forests, thereby bringing a positive change in the attitude towards the girl child. As part of the scheme, saplings have been distributed to the parents of 23320 girls. Rs 5.64 crore has been spent on the scheme.

HIMCARE

This medical insurance scheme has proved to be a boon for the people in the state of Himachal Pradesh. Under the